# SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

**11 September 2023 · Shift 3**

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

## Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

**Q.4**

By selling a cycle for ₹5,800, a man gains 45%. What will be the cost price of the cycle?

**(A)** ₹3,000
**(B)** ₹4,500
**(C)** ₹4,000
**(D)** ₹3,500

## Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 1 question

**Q.19**

Seven people, V, F, D, S, R, C, and P are sitting in a straight line, facing south. Only two people sit between V and P. Only two people sit to the right of V. D sits third to the left of S. P is an immediate neighbour of D and F. C is an immediate neighbour of S. Total how many people sit between S and P?

**(A)** Four
**(B)** One
**(C)** Three
**(D)** Two

## General Awareness 22 questions

**Q.1**

In which year did the ‘Battle of Buxar’ take place?

**(A)** 1764 CE
**(B)** 1769 CE
**(C)** 1757 CE
**(D)** 1761 CE

**Q.2**

Which Article of the Indian Constitution mandates that the state should protect every monument or place of artistic or historic interest?

**(A)** Article 39A
**(B)** Article 50
**(C)** Article 49
**(D)** Article 48A

**Q.3**

To mark the celebration of Gandhi Jayanti, the _____ celebrates it as International Day of Non-Violence.

**(A)** United Nations
**(B)** BRICS Nations
**(C)** South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation
**(D)** Group of 20

**Q.4**

Alarmel Valli is a _____ dancer.

**(A)** Bharatnatyam
**(B)** Odissi
**(C)** Kuchipudi
**(D)** Kathak

**Q.5**

Which of the following is an example of a microfinance institution (MFI) in India?

**(A)** State Bank of India (SBI)
**(B)** Bandhan Bank
**(C)** ICICI Bank
**(D)** HDFC Bank

**Q.6**

Which of the following is an autobiography by Mahatma Gandhi?

**(A)** The Story of My Experiments with Truth
**(B)** My Truth
**(C)** Matters of Discretion
**(D)** My Country My Life

**Q.7**

Which of the following has initiated the Village Defence Guards scheme to instil a sense of self protection and ensure the safety and security of villages and infrastructural installations in and around the villages?

**(A)** Ladakh
**(B)** Uttar Pradesh
**(C)** Jammu and Kashmir
**(D)** Rajasthan

**Q.8**

The Sirpur Shrine is situated in which of the following states?

**(A)** Odisha
**(B)** Uttar Pradesh
**(C)** Chhattisgarh
**(D)** Bihar

**Q.10**

What is the common name for a saturated solution of calcium hydroxide widely used as a raw material in the chemical industry?

**(A)** Slaked lime
**(B)** Calomel
**(C)** Burnt Lime
**(D)** Limestone

**Q.11**

Who among the following singers is from Andhra Pradesh?

**(A)** Usha Uthup
**(B)** Asha Bhosle
**(C)** Alka Yagnik
**(D)** S Janaki

**Q.12**

Who led the Congress in the second round table conference held in London?

**(A)** Annie Besant
**(B)** Sarojini Naidu
**(C)** Jawahar Lal Nehru
**(D)** Mahatma Gandhi

**Q.13**

According to the Census of India 2011, which state has the second highest sex ratio?

**(A)** Kerala
**(B)** Tamil Nadu
**(C)** Assam
**(D)** Bihar

**Q.14**

Factor cost is also known as:

**(A)** market cost
**(B)** ex-factory cost
**(C)** input cost
**(D)** output cost

**Q.15**
Which cell found in the bone marrow acts as a repair system for the body?

**(A)** Bone Cells
**(B)** Fat Cells
**(C)** Muscle cells
**(D)** Stem cells

**Q.16**
Which of the following is a famous folk dance of Rajasthan?

**(A)** Chang Lo
**(B)** Daskathia
**(C)** Kalbelia
**(D)** Pala Jatra

**Q.17**
When was the first general election for Lok Sabha held in India?

**(A)** 1950-51
**(B)** 1949-50
**(C)** 1948-49
**(D)** 1951-52

**Q.18**
Who among the following female singers has been felicitated with the Bharat Ratna?

**(A)** Usha Uthup
**(B)** Lata Mangeshkar
**(C)** Asha Bhosle
**(D)** Vani Jayaram

**Q.19**
Which of the following states of India is the first to receive rainfall from the South West Monsoon?

**(A)** Himachal Pradesh
**(B)** Kerala
**(C)** Telangana
**(D)** Rajasthan

**Q.22**
India played in the finals of the 2023 World Test Championship against Australia. Where was this match conducted?

**(A)** Dubai
**(B)** London
**(C)** Kolkata
**(D)** Sydney

**Q.23**
D Gukesh was awarded player of the year award in March 2023. He plays which sport?

**(A)** Snooker
**(B)** Boxing
**(C)** Badminton
**(D)** Chess

**Q.24**
According to the Ministry of Textile 2022-23, which state is the second largest producer of cotton?

**(A)** Maharashtra
**(B)** Bihar
**(C)** Gujarat
**(D)** Madhya Pradesh

**Q.25**
In which of the following States was the final of the 2023 Intercontinental Cup football championship held?

**(A)** Maharashtra
**(B)** Telangana
**(C)** Karnataka
**(D)** Odisha

## English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

**Q.1**
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Humorous
**(B)** Necassery
**(C)** Apparent
**(D)** Definite

**Q.2**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A small shop that sells fashionable clothes

**(A)** Boutique
**(B)** Store
**(C)** Tailoring
**(D)** Couture

**Q.3**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The blue is a beautiful colour.

**(A)** The blue
**(B)** is
**(C)** a
**(D)** beautiful colour

**Q.4**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Nile is the _____ river of the world.

**(A)** long
**(B)** longer
**(C)** more longer
**(D)** longest

**Q.5**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Tuntun and her friends dance beautiful.

**(A)** dance
**(B)** and her friends
**(C)** Tuntun
**(D)** beautiful

**Q.6**

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. It's risky to invest all your savings in one company; it's like _____.

**(A)** going down in flames
**(B)** putting all your eggs in one basket
**(C)** biting the bullet
**(D)** breaking a leg

**Q.7**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Sometimes we have to accept "replacing something with something else", if we want to move forward.

**(A)** evaluation
**(B)** change
**(C)** invasion
**(D)** invention

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Dishevelled

**(A)** Assertive
**(B)** Tidy
**(C)** Tainted
**(D)** Rigid

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I _____ to many countries to find the source of true happiness.

**(A)** triveled
**(B)** travelled
**(C)** travalled
**(D)** travelld

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. Irrespective of the chaos in the classroom, our class teacher stays "cool as a cucumber".

**(A)** Stays calm and composed
**(B)** Behaves like a vegetable
**(C)** Scolds all the students in the classroom
**(D)** Develops a fever

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Hazard

**(A)** Marvel
**(B)** Miracle
**(C)** Ardent
**(D)** Accident

**Q.13**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He is a smug and very _____ person who thinks only about himself.

**(A)** arsonist
**(B)** diffident
**(C)** egoistic
**(D)** humble

**Q.14**

Select the word segment which substitutes the bracketed word correctly and completes the sentence meaningfully. I (am here) since 1981.

**(A)** have been here
**(B)** had been here
**(C)** was here
**(D)** has been here

**Q.15**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. You shall repented tomorrow for your misdeeds.

**(A)** for your misdeeds
**(B)** tomorrow
**(C)** shall repented
**(D)** You

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. She “think” Alex is abandoning her.

**(A)** was thinking
**(B)** thought
**(C)** thinks
**(D)** was to think

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate segment that can substitute the bracketed word in the following sentence. The bridge that (connecting) the two valleys across the Brahmaputra river has recently been constructed in Arunachal Pradesh.

**(A)** will be connecting
**(B)** had connected
**(C)** will be connected
**(D)** connects

**Q.18**

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Naina has six children, and I always _____ with their names.

**(A)** get mixed up
**(B)** get rid of
**(C)** get away clean
**(D)** get cold feet

**Q.19**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. When it comes to planning her wedding, Maria wants _____.

**(A)** down for the count
**(B)** a black sheep
**(C)** the whole fifteen miles
**(D)** the whole nine yards

**Q.20**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I know that I can count on my best friend to be by my side through ____ and thin.

**(A)** tough
**(B)** heavy
**(C)** thick
**(D)** fat

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I do not know how the party ended. I do not want to know. I went (1)___ upstairs, and undressed and (2)___ into bed, and lay there in the burning dark while the last guest gurgled in the hall below about the wonderful evening she had spent. I lay there (3)___ the front door shut after her, and Lavinia's steps came up the stairs and passed the door to the guest room beyond. And then after a couple of centuries (4)___, the clock struck three and I (5)___ to sleep.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

**(A)** over
**(B)** through
**(C)** around
**(D)** straight

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I do not know how the party ended. I do not want to know. I went (1)___ upstairs, and undressed and (2)___ into bed, and lay there in the burning dark while the last guest gurgled in the hall below about the wonderful evening she had spent. I lay there (3)___ the front door shut after her, and Lavinia's steps came up the stairs and passed the door to the guest room beyond. And then after a couple of centuries (4)___, the clock struck three and I (5)___ to sleep.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

**(A)** gnawed
**(B)** lurched
**(C)** peeped
**(D)** crawled

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I do not know how the party ended. I do not want to know. I went (1)___ upstairs, and undressed and (2)___ into bed, and lay there in the burning dark while the last guest gurgled in the hall below about the wonderful evening she had spent. I lay there (3)___ the front door shut after her, and Lavinia's steps came up the stairs and passed the door to the guest room beyond. And then after a couple of centuries (4)___, the clock struck three and I (5)___ to sleep.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

**(A)** still
**(B)** toward
**(C)** while
**(D)** down

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I do not know how the party ended. I do not want to know. I went (1)___ upstairs, and undressed and (2)___ into bed, and lay there in the burning dark while the last guest gurgled in the hall below about the wonderful evening she had spent. I lay there (3)___ the front door shut after her, and Lavinia's steps came up the stairs and passed the door to the guest room beyond. And then after a couple of centuries (4)___, the clock struck three and I (5)___ to sleep.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

**(A)** crossed
**(B)** eroded
**(C)** elapsed
**(D)** persisted

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I do not know how the party ended. I do not want to know. I went (1)___ upstairs, and undressed and (2)___ into bed, and lay there in the burning dark while the last guest gurgled in the hall below about the wonderful evening she had spent. I lay there (3)___ the front door shut after her, and Lavinia's steps came up the stairs and passed the door to the guest room beyond. And then after a couple of centuries (4)___, the clock struck three and I (5)___ to sleep.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

**(A)** dozed off

**(B)** called off

**(C)** took off

**(D)** put off

## Answer key

### Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.4 **(C)**

### Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.19 **(C)**

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.2 **(C)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(A)** |
| Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.12 **(D)** | Q.13 **(B)** |
| Q.14 **(C)** | Q.15 **(D)** | Q.16 **(C)** | Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(B)** | Q.19 **(B)** |
| Q.22 **(B)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(D)** | | |

### English Language and Comprehension

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.2 **(A)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(D)** | Q.6 **(B)** |
| Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(B)** | Q.11 **(A)** | Q.12 **(D)** | Q.13 **(C)** |
| Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(C)** | Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(A)** | Q.19 **(D)** |
| Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(A)** |

## Explanations

### Numerical and Mathematical Ability

**Q.4 · Answer (C) ₹4,000**

₹5,800 is 145% of the cost price, so CP = 5800 × 100/145 = ₹4,000.

### Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Three**

Number the seats 1 to 7 from the right end of the row (the people face south). Only two sit to V's right, so V is 3rd; two people between V and P put P 6th, and D and F, its neighbours, in 5th and 7th; D third to the left of S puts S in 2nd (D in 7th would put S in 4th, between V and F, leaving no seat for C beside S), so C is 1st and R 4th. V, R and D sit between S and P: three people.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (A) 1764 CE**

At Buxar in October 1764 the East India Company's army under Hector Munro defeated the combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula of Awadh and the Mughal emperor Shah Alam II. Plassey was fought in 1757 and the Third Battle of Panipat in 1761.

**Q.2 · Answer (C) Article 49**

Article 49, a Directive Principle, obliges the State to protect every monument or place or object of artistic or historic interest declared by or under a law made by Parliament to be of national importance. Article 39A provides for free legal aid, 48A for the environment and 50 for separating the judiciary from the executive.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) United Nations**

In June 2007 the UN General Assembly declared 2 October, Gandhi's birthday, the International Day of Non-Violence.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Bharatnatyam**

Alarmel Valli, of Chennai, is one of India's leading Bharatanatyam dancers, of the Pandanallur style.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) Bandhan Bank**

Bandhan began at Konnagar, near Kolkata, in 2001 as a microfinance lender and grew into one of India's largest microfinance institutions before it became Bandhan Bank, a universal bank, in 2015. SBI, ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank are mainstream commercial banks.

**Q.6 · Answer (A) The Story of My Experiments with Truth**

Gandhi's autobiography, 'The Story of My Experiments with Truth', was written in Gujarati and serialised in Navajivan from 1925 to 1929. 'My Truth' is Indira Gandhi's, 'Matters of Discretion' I. K. Gujral's and 'My Country My Life' L. K. Advani's.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) Jammu and Kashmir**

Under the Village Defence Guards scheme, approved by the Union Home Ministry in 2022 and in force in Jammu and Kashmir from August 2022, groups of armed civilian volunteers guard border and remote villages; it replaced the Village Defence Committees of the 1990s.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Chhattisgarh**

Sirpur, on the Mahanadi in Mahasamund district of Chhattisgarh, is known for the 7th-century brick Lakshmana temple and the remains of Buddhist monasteries.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) Slaked lime**

SSC's key gives slaked lime, the common name of calcium hydroxide, $Ca(OH)_2$; strictly, its clear saturated solution in water is called limewater. Calomel is mercury(I) chloride, burnt lime (quicklime) is calcium oxide and limestone is calcium carbonate.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) S Janaki**
The playback singer S. Janaki was born in 1938 at Pallapatla in Guntur district, Andhra Pradesh. Usha Uthup was born in Bombay, Asha Bhosle in Sangli (Maharashtra) and Alka Yagnik in Calcutta.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) Mahatma Gandhi**
After the Gandhi-Irwin Pact the Congress took part in the Second Round Table Conference in London (September-December 1931), with Gandhi as its sole representative.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu**
In the 2011 Census Kerala had the highest sex ratio among the states, 1,084 females per 1,000 males, and Tamil Nadu the second highest, 996.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) input cost**
Factor cost is what is paid to the factors of production, the inputs land, labour, capital and enterprise (rent, wages, interest and profit), hence 'input cost'. Unlike market price it leaves out indirect taxes and includes subsidies.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) Stem cells**
Bone marrow holds stem cells, unspecialised cells that keep dividing and can turn into blood cells and other kinds of cell, replacing worn-out or damaged ones.

**Q.16 · Answer (C) Kalbelia**
Kalbelia, the dance of Rajasthan's Kalbelia snake-charmer community, was inscribed on UNESCO's intangible cultural heritage list in 2010. Chang Lo is a dance of Nagaland, and Daskathia and Pala are performance forms of Odisha.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) 1951-52**
India's first general election, to the first Lok Sabha, was held from October 1951 to February 1952.

**Q.18 · Answer (B) Lata Mangeshkar**
Lata Mangeshkar received the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian award, in 2001.

**Q.19 · Answer (B) Kerala**
The southwest monsoon normally sets in over Kerala around 1 June, its first landfall on the mainland, and then advances northwards.

**Q.22 · Answer (B) London**
The 2023 World Test Championship final was played at The Oval, London, in June 2023; Australia beat India by 209 runs.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) Chess**
D. Gukesh of Chennai is a chess grandmaster; the Asian Chess Federation named him its Player of the Year in March 2023, after his gold medal on the top board at the 2022 Chess Olympiad.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) Maharashtra**
In the Textiles Ministry's provisional estimates for 2022-23 Gujarat produced the most cotton, about 92 lakh bales, and Maharashtra came second with about 80 lakh bales.

**Q.25 · Answer (D) Odisha**
The 2023 Intercontinental Cup was played at the Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar, in June 2023; India beat Lebanon 2-0 in the final.

### English Language and Comprehension

**Q.1 · Answer (B) Necassery**
The correct spelling is 'necessary'.

**Q.2 · Answer (A) Boutique**
A 'boutique' is a small shop selling fashionable clothes; 'couture' is the designing and making of such clothes, not a shop.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) The blue**
A colour named in a general sense takes no article: 'Blue is a beautiful colour.'

**Q.4 · Answer (D) longest**
Comparing the Nile with all the world's rivers needs the superlative 'the longest'; 'more longer' is a double comparative.

**Q.5 · Answer (D) beautiful**
'Dance' is a verb and is modified by an adverb: 'dance beautifully'.

**Q.6 · Answer (B) putting all your eggs in one basket**
To 'put all your eggs in one basket' is to risk everything on a single venture.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) change**
Replacing something with something else is a 'change': we sometimes have to accept change to move forward.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) Tidy**
'Dishevelled' means untidy, of hair, clothes or appearance; its opposite is 'tidy'.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) travelled**
The correct spelling is 'travelled' (British usage doubles the final 'l'; American English has 'traveled').

**Q.11 · Answer (A) Stays calm and composed**
'Cool as a cucumber' means calm and composed, even under pressure.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) Accident**
SSC's key gives 'accident': 'hazard' can mean chance or mishap, as in 'by hazard', and none of the other options is related. In everyday use, though, 'hazard' means a danger or risk, so 'accident' is only a loose synonym.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) egoistic**
An 'egoistic' person thinks only of himself, which fits 'smug'; 'diffident' (shy) and 'humble' are near opposites, and an 'arsonist' sets fires.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) have been here**
A state lasting from a point in the past up to now, with 'since', takes the present perfect, and 'I' takes 'have': 'I have been here since 1981.'

**Q.15 · Answer (C) shall repented**
A modal such as 'shall' takes the base form of the verb: 'You shall repent tomorrow'.

**Q.16 · Answer (C) thinks**
The singular subject 'She' takes 'thinks' in the simple present, which also matches 'is abandoning'.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) connects**
The relative clause needs a finite verb, and the bridge, now built, joins the valleys: 'that connects'.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) get mixed up**
To 'get mixed up' is to confuse one thing with another, here the six children's names.

**Q.19 · Answer (D) the whole nine yards**
'The whole nine yards' means everything possible, every last detail.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) thick**
'Through thick and thin' means in good times and bad.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) straight**
To go 'straight upstairs' is to go directly, without stopping.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) crawled**
'Crawled into bed' is the usual phrase for getting wearily into bed; one does not 'gnaw' or 'peep' into bed.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) while**

'While' joins two things happening at the same time: the narrator lay there while the front door shut after the guest.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) elapsed**

Time 'elapses', or passes: after what felt like a couple of centuries had passed, the clock struck three.

**Q.25 · Answer (A) dozed off**

To 'doze off' is to fall asleep; 'call off' means to cancel, 'take off' to leave the ground and 'put off' to postpone.

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